

Privacy Policy

Nyaya Saathi — AI-Assisted Legal Navigation Platform

Effective date: [Insert Effective Date] | Version 1.0 (Hackathon / Pilot Build)

Legal cases often involve sensitive information — financial details, identity documents, family or criminal matters. This policy explains, in plain language, what we collect, why, how it is protected, and the choices and rights you have over it, including under India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 ("DPDP Act").

This Privacy Policy explains how the Nyaya Saathi team ("we," "us," "our") collects, uses, discloses, and protects personal data when you use the Nyaya Saathi website, mobile interface, and related services (the "Service"). It should be read together with our Terms & Conditions. By using the Service, you acknowledge this Policy.

1. Data We Collect

1.1 Data you provide directly

Category	Examples	Why we collect it
Account data	Name, email address, phone number, password (hashed), preferred language	Create and secure your account; communicate with you
Case data	Free-text problem description, answers to follow-up questions, category, urgency, dates, amounts, involved parties, location	Classify your issue, run retrieval, generate your action plan
Evidence / files	Uploaded PDFs, screenshots, photos of documents, and any personal data they contain (which may include identifiers such as partial ID numbers, bank details, or correspondence)	Extract case-relevant facts via OCR; build your evidence checklist
Communications	Messages you send us, support requests, feedback, chat interactions with the AI assistant	Respond to you; improve the Service

1.2 Data collected automatically

- Device and usage data: IP address, browser type, device identifiers, pages visited, timestamps, and general error/performance logs, used for security, debugging, and service reliability.
- Authentication data: session tokens and login timestamps, used to keep your account secure.
- Audit-trail data: a record of privileged actions on your case (for example, case access or deletion) for accountability and security investigations.

1.3 What we do not knowingly collect

- We do not knowingly collect data from children under 18.
- We do not require government ID numbers, full bank account numbers, or OTPs to be entered into text fields; where such details appear inside an uploaded document, see Section 4 (Sensitive Data) for how they are handled.

2. How We Use Your Data

- To operate the Service: create your case, run issue classification, retrieve relevant legal information (RAG), extract evidence via OCR, and generate your action plan and document drafts.
- To secure the Service: authenticate you, detect abuse or unauthorised access, and maintain audit logs of privileged operations.
- To communicate with you: service notices, status updates on your case, and responses to support requests.
- To improve the Service: aggregated, de-identified analytics on feature usage and retrieval quality. We exclude raw document contents and sensitive fields from analytics.
- To comply with legal obligations, respond to lawful requests from authorities, and enforce our Terms.

We do not use your case data or evidence to train third-party foundation models, and we do not sell your personal data to advertisers or data brokers.

3. Legal Basis / Consent

We process your personal data on the basis of your consent (given when you register and submit a case), to perform our contract with you (providing the Service you requested), and, where applicable, to comply with legal obligations. You may withdraw consent at any time by deleting your account, subject to Section 8; withdrawal does not affect processing already carried out.

4. Sensitive Data in Evidence

Evidence you upload may incidentally contain sensitive personal data, such as ID numbers, bank details, or medical information. We apply data-minimisation principles to how this data is handled:

- Evidence files are stored in access-controlled object storage and served only via short-lived, signed URLs to your authenticated session — there are no public file links.
- We do not log full document contents, passwords, authentication tokens, full Aadhaar or other national ID numbers, full bank account numbers, or OTPs. Where such values must be referenced internally for processing, they are masked or truncated in logs.
- Access to evidence is restricted to your account and to the specific backend processes needed to serve your case; every case-level API call verifies that the requesting user owns the case.
- Encryption is applied in transit (TLS) for all data sent to and from the Service, and at rest where the underlying storage provider supports it.

5. AI Processing and Third-Party Providers

To generate case summaries, retrieval results, and action plans, portions of your case description and extracted evidence text may be sent to third-party AI model providers (for example, OpenAI or Google Gemini, depending on configuration) for processing. These providers act as our data processors under contractual terms that restrict them from using your data to train their own models except where their standard enterprise/API terms already exclude such training, and from retaining data longer than necessary to return a response.

Legal-information retrieval draws on a curated knowledge base built from official and authoritative public sources (for example, India Code, eCourts Services, NALSA, and the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal). Retrieval queries derived from your case may be sent to our vector database and AI providers as described above.

6. How We Share Data

- Service providers: cloud hosting, object storage, database, and AI-model providers who process data on our behalf, under contractual confidentiality and security obligations.
- Legal / official escalation, at your direction: if you choose to use a link to an official portal (for example, the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal or NALSA), that submission is made directly by you to that third party under its own privacy terms — we do not automatically transmit your case to government systems on your behalf unless you explicitly initiate that action.
- Legal compliance: where required to comply with a valid legal process, protect rights and safety, or prevent fraud or abuse of the Service.
- Business transfers: if the project or its assets are transferred (for example, from a hackathon prototype into a registered company), your data may transfer as part of that process, subject to equivalent protections and prior notice to you.

We do not sell personal data, and we do not share your case data or evidence with advertisers.

7. Data Retention

- Account and case data are retained for as long as your account is active, or until you delete your case or account.
- Uploaded evidence files are retained only as long as needed to serve your case, or until you delete them; raw file contents are not retained beyond processing unless you have explicitly chosen to keep them as part of your case record.
- Security and audit logs are retained for a bounded period sufficient for security investigations and then deleted or anonymised, and are designed to avoid storing sensitive content.
- We may retain limited data after account deletion where required to comply with a legal obligation, resolve disputes, or enforce our agreements.

8. Your Rights

Subject to applicable law (including the DPDP Act, 2023, where it applies to you), you have the right to:

- Access the personal data we hold about you and how it is processed.
- Correct inaccurate or incomplete personal data.
- Request erasure of your personal data, including account and case deletion, subject to Section 7.
- Withdraw consent for processing that relies on consent, at any time.
- Nominate another individual to exercise these rights on your behalf in the event of death or incapacity, where required by applicable law.
- Lodge a grievance with our Grievance Officer (Section 12) and, if unresolved, with the applicable data protection authority.

You can exercise most of these rights directly from your account settings (profile, case, and evidence deletion). For anything else, contact us using the details in Section 12.

9. Security Measures

- Encryption in transit (TLS) and at rest where supported by our infrastructure providers.
- Role-based access control and object-level authorisation, so a case is only ever accessible to its owner (and, where applicable, an authorised support or admin role acting under audit).
- Password hashing, secure session handling, and rate limiting on authentication endpoints.
- File-type and size validation on uploads, with no public file URLs — only short-lived signed links.
- Audit trails for privileged operations (for example, admin access to a case).

No system can be guaranteed 100% secure. If we become aware of a data breach affecting your personal data, we will notify you and the relevant authority as required by applicable law.

10. Cookies and Similar Technologies

We use essential cookies or local storage to keep you signed in and to remember basic preferences such as language. We do not use third-party advertising trackers. If analytics cookies are introduced in future, we will update this Policy and provide appropriate controls.

11. International Data Transfers

Our infrastructure and AI-model providers may process data outside India. Where personal data is transferred internationally, we rely on the service providers' contractual and technical safeguards and comply with applicable cross-border transfer requirements under Indian law.

12. Grievance Officer / Contact

In accordance with applicable Indian law, you may contact our Grievance Officer with any questions, requests, or complaints about this Policy or our handling of your personal data:

- Name: [Insert Grievance Officer Name]
- Email: [Insert Grievance Officer Email]
- Postal address: [Insert Postal Address]
- We aim to acknowledge grievances promptly and resolve them within the timeframe required by applicable law.

13. Children's Privacy

The Service is not directed to individuals under 18. If we learn that we have collected personal data from a child without appropriate consent, we will take steps to delete it.

14. Changes to This Policy

We may update this Policy as the Service evolves. Material changes will be reflected in an updated "Effective date" above, and, where feasible, we will notify you in-app or by email before the change takes effect.